



Huge pipe sponges sprout among the corals of a reef.

Air-breathing seals rely on holes in the ice to survive.

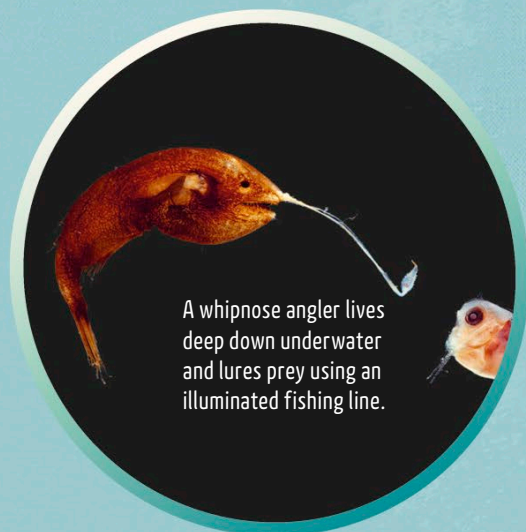


Polar seas

At the Earth's poles, the sun's rays are too feeble to generate much warmth, meaning oceans are so cold that ice forms on the surface. Yet fish, seals, and whales thrive in the fertile water underneath, which is rich with sea creatures to feed on.

Deep sea

The deep sea is the Earth's biggest habitat. Most of it is cold and black because sunlight cannot reach it, but even here there is life.



A whipnose angler lives deep down underwater and lures prey using an illuminated fishing line.

Open ocean

Microscopic algae float at the surface of the ocean and make a tasty meal for fish, whales, and other sea creatures. In open waters, there is nowhere to hide—and animals must blend in or have the speed to escape danger or catch prey.

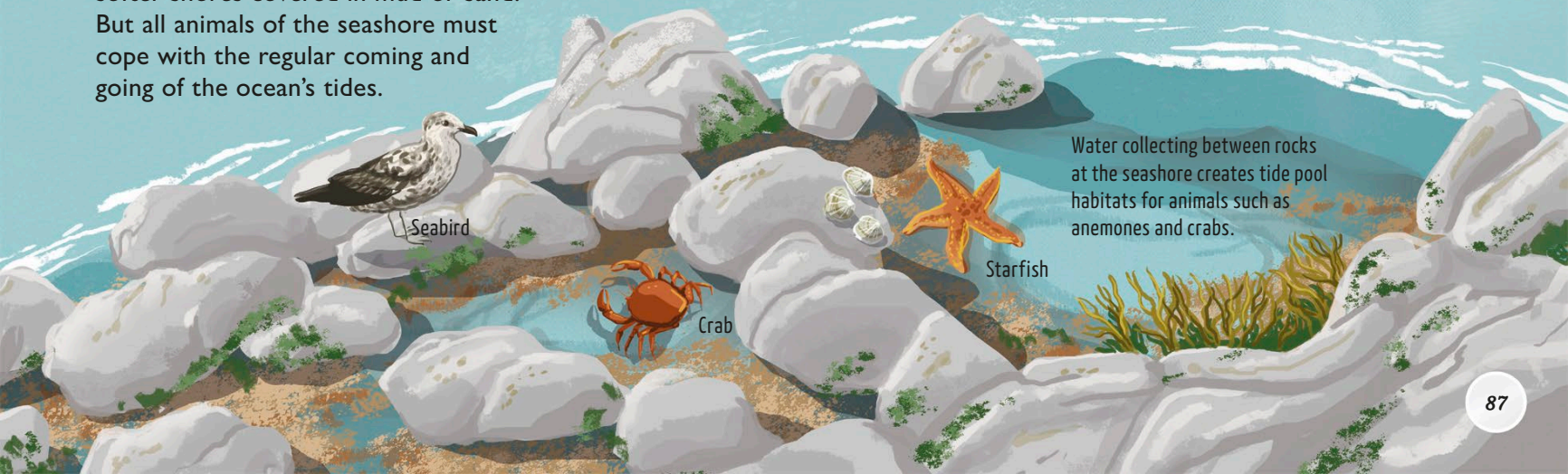


Orcas are large ocean predators. They work together in groups to hunt seals and other prey.

Saltwater

Seashore

Some coastal animals prefer shorelines that are hard and rocky. Others need softer shores covered in mud or sand. But all animals of the seashore must cope with the regular coming and going of the ocean's tides.



Seabird

Crab

Starfish

Water collecting between rocks at the seashore creates tide pool habitats for animals such as anemones and crabs.